

User Instructions

Web Browsing and Tracking Study

Thank you for participating in our research study. Please follow the instructions below carefully to ensure that your participation is valid.

Study Requirements:

Before you begin, please ensure that you meet all of the following requirements:

- Use Google Chrome.
 - Do not use a VPN during the study.
 - Start with a clean browser profile by clearing browsing data (cookies, history, and cache).
 - Disable or remove all other browser extensions, including ad blockers and privacy tools.
 - Install only the study extension provided by the research team.
 - Keep the extension enabled throughout the study.
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Study Task:

You will receive a list of websites assigned to you. For each assigned website:

1. Open the website.
 2. Browse naturally.
 3. Visit at least 10 different subpages within that website.
 4. Examples of subpages include product pages, articles, category pages, help pages, documentation pages, or user profile pages.
 5. Spend a reasonable amount of time browsing each page before moving to the next one.
 6. Repeat this process for every website assigned to you.
 7. The extension will automatically collect the required study data while you browse.
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Part 1 - Clear Browser Data:

Before installing the study extension, clear your browser data.

1. Open Chrome.

2. Press Ctrl + Shift + Delete (Windows/Linux) or ⌘ + Shift + Delete (Mac).
3. Set Time Range to All time.
4. Check:
5. Browsing history
6. Cookies and other site data
7. Cached images and files
8. Click Delete data.
9. Close and reopen Chrome.

Part 2 - Install the Unpacked Extension:

You will receive a folder containing the study extension.

1. *Step 1*
 - 1) Extract the ZIP file provided.
 - 2) You should have a folder containing files such as:
 - 3) manifest.json
 - 4) background.js (or similar)
 - 5) icons/
 - 6) other extension files
 - 7) Do not rename or modify these files.
2. *Step 2*
 - a. Open Chrome and navigate to:
 - b. `chrome://extensions`
3. *Step 3*
 - a. Enable Developer mode using the toggle in the upper-right corner.
4. *Step 4*
 - a. Click Load unpacked.
5. *Step 5*
 - a. Select the extracted extension folder.
6. *Step 6*
 - a. Verify that the extension appears in the Extensions page and is enabled.
 - b. If prompted for permissions, click Allow.

Part 3 — Complete the Study:

- 1) Keep the extension enabled.
- 2) Visit every website assigned to you.

- 3) Browse at least 10 subpages for each website.
- 4) Do not install any additional extensions.
- 5) Do not clear browser data during the study.
- 6) Do not use Incognito Mode unless instructed.
- 7) Do not use a VPN.

Part 4 — Remove the Extension

After completing the study,

- 1) Paste `chrome://extensions` in your browser's URL field, or go to Sidebar>Extensions>Manage Extensions
- 2) Locate the study extension.
- 3) Click Remove.
- 4) Confirm by clicking Remove again.

Troubleshooting

- "Load unpacked" button is missing
 - Make sure Developer mode is enabled on the Extensions page.
- Chrome reports "Manifest file is missing"
 - Ensure you selected the extension folder itself, not its parent directory.
 - The selected folder should directly contain `manifest.json`
- Extension appears disabled
 - Enable it using the toggle on the Extensions page.
- If Chrome displays an error, contact the study administrator.

Important Notes - Your participation will be considered valid only if:

- 1) You use a supported Chromium-based browser.
- 2) You begin with a clean browser instance.
- 3) No VPN is active.
- 4) No additional browser extensions are enabled.
- 5) You install only the provided study extension.
- 6) You visit every assigned website.
- 7) You browse at least 10 subpages for each assigned website.
- 8) You keep the extension enabled for the entire browsing session.

Thank you for participating in this research study.

